

POLARIZED RAMIFICATION AND HIGHER-CORANK STRUCTURE IN MULTIPLICATION FAILURE

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ABSTRACT. We study the scheme of multiplication failure for cube-zero algebras with Hilbert function $(1, 4, 6)$. Its nilpotent structure determines not only an abstract ramification K3 surface but its quartic polarization. The reconstruction uses the canonical bundle of the intrinsic embedded support and its nilradical module to recover a Veronese section ring. The resulting family has a nine-dimensional image in polarized K3 moduli, and the relation tensor is determined up to finitely many projective equivalence classes over a general point of that image. We also determine the fixed-tensor primary structure on a nonempty open part of the projection-corank-two stratum. Four ramification branches meet there, and a further embedded component makes the nilradical have index three, with square of transverse length one. On the corank-one locus we retain the ramification normal form, all ordinary ideal powers, and their intrinsic torsion, and establish precise relative flatness and base-change statements. The polarized reconstruction applies to the failure scheme on the whole Grassmannian, since the smooth locus of its reduction is intrinsic. The proof includes an explicit rational relation system and exact finite rank certificates.

1. INTRODUCTION AND STATEMENTS

A scheme defined by failure of a multiplication map can carry geometric information which disappears upon reduction. We exhibit such information in a finite local algebra: the scheme remembers a polarized K3 surface, although its reduced divisor is a fixed rational Schubert variety. The reconstruction is obtained from a line bundle intrinsic to the embedded nilpotent structure, rather than from an ambient marking or from birational cancellation.

Let V be a complex vector space of dimension $e \in \{3, 4\}$, and put $p = e(e-1)/2$. For an e -dimensional relation space $R \subset \text{Sym}^2 V$, write

$$S_R = \text{Sym}^2 V/R, \quad B_R = \mathbb{C} \oplus V \oplus S_R. \quad (1.1)$$

Multiplication on V is the quotient map γ_R , and $(V \oplus S_R)S_R = 0$. Thus the maximal ideal has cube zero. Set $X_R = \text{Gr}(e, V \oplus S_R)$ and let $\mathcal{K}$ be its rank- e tautological subbundle. A point K determines the unital subspace $\mathbb{C}1 \oplus K \subset B_R$. For any $m \geq 2$ define

$$\widehat{D}_R = V(\text{Fitt}_0 \text{coker}[\text{Sym}^m(\mathcal{O} \oplus \mathcal{K}) \longrightarrow B_R \otimes \mathcal{O}]). \quad (1.2)$$

The scheme is independent of $m \geq 2$; in particular, ordinary powers of its ideal below must not be confused with changing m .

We regard a relation $q \in R$ as a quadratic polynomial on V^* . Let $G_e^\circ \subset \text{Gr}(e, \text{Sym}^2 V)$ consist of the basepoint-free systems whose Jacobian hypersurface

$$Y_R = V(\det(\partial q_i/\partial x_j)) \subset \mathbb{P}(V^*) \quad (1.3)$$

is smooth. This is a nonempty invariant open set. Its members are ramification schemes of finite quadratic morphisms of degree 2^{e-1} ; Y_R is a genus-one curve for $e = 3$ and a quartic K3 surface for $e = 4$.

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Write $\widehat{\Delta}_R = \{\text{rank}(K \rightarrow V) < e\}$, and let U_R be the open set where this rank is at least $e - 1$. Set $D_R = \widehat{D}_R \cap U_R$ and $\Delta_R = \widehat{\Delta}_R \cap U_R$. If $\mathcal{N}_R$ is the nilradical of $\mathcal{O}_{D_R}$, its annihilator defines an intrinsic smooth scheme $E_R \subset D_R$, and $\mathcal{N}_R$ is an invertible $\mathcal{O}_{E_R}$ -module. The following is the main reconstruction statement.

Theorem 1.1 (Polarized reconstruction). *For $R \in G_e^\circ$, put*

$$\mathcal{L}_R = \omega_{E_R} \otimes \mathcal{N}_R^{\otimes -(p+e-1)}.$$

There is an isomorphism of graded algebras

$$\bigoplus_{n \geq 0} H^0(E_R, \mathcal{L}_R^{\otimes n}) \simeq \bigoplus_{n \geq 0} H^0(Y_R, \mathcal{O}_{Y_R}(en)). \quad (1.4)$$

Consequently D_R determines $(Y_R, \mathcal{O}_{Y_R}(e))$. For $e = 4$ it determines $(Y_R, \mathcal{O}_{Y_R}(1))$. The same conclusions hold with $\widehat{D}_R$ in place of D_R . No isomorphism is required to preserve X_R , R , or any projection.

The passage from E_R to its section ring is essential. Stable birational cancellation recovers the abstract surface, but not the polarization. Here a cancellation of two determinant line bundles produces the fourth power of the quartic polarization; its section ring descends without extra functions in the affine-bundle directions.

Theorem 1.2 (Variation and finite ambiguity). *For $e = 4$, the image of $R \mapsto (Y_R, \mathcal{O}_{Y_R}(1))$ in the moduli space of quartic K3 surfaces has dimension nine. On a nonempty invariant open, the induced map from projective equivalence classes of relation spaces to its image is generically finite. Thus, over a general point of this image, D_R determines at most finitely many isomorphism classes of algebras B_R ; the same is true for $\widehat{D}_R$.*

The dimension assertion is a statement about the actual ramification surfaces, not an orbit count for unrelated algebras. We prove it by a 25×25 integral determinant for the differential of the Jacobian map on a 24-dimensional Grassmannian chart.

The next statement describes the first higher-corank stratum. Its precise open hypotheses are given in Definition 6.1. They are verified by the same rational relation system used for the moduli calculation.

Theorem 1.3 (A corank-two embedded component). *There is a nonempty invariant open $G_4^\dagger \subset G_4^\circ$ such that, for each $R \in G_4^\dagger$, a dense open set of rank-two images $H \subset V$ satisfies the following assertion. Near any plane K with image such an H , after an étale local extension and smooth auxiliary coordinates, the fixed-tensor failure ideal has an irredundant primary decomposition*

$$\mathcal{I}_{\widehat{D}_R} = (\delta) \cap P_1^2 \cap P_2^2 \cap P_3^2 \cap P_4^2 \cap \mathfrak{m}^5, \quad \delta = ad - bc, \quad \mathfrak{m} = (a, b, c, d). \quad (1.5)$$

Each P_i is the ideal of matrices whose image lies in one of the four ramification lines in V/H . Besides the reduced divisor and the four local ramification branches, the rank-two stratum is an associated support. Its nilradical has index three. The square of the nilradical is an invertible module on that stratum, of transverse length one.

In particular, the higher-corank contribution is not obtained by continuing the two-parameter model $t(t, f)$ unchanged: it contains additional associated information. The theorem is a fixed-tensor calculation, not a specialization of a generic-matrix primary intersection. It covers the stated open part of corank two; it does not classify its exceptional complement or projection corank at least three. By contrast, Theorem 1.1 concerns isomorphisms of the failure scheme on the whole X_R .

Relation with classical constructions. The quadratic morphism and its bilinear incidence surface are classical linear-system constructions. In particular, the incidence realization of the K3 cover associated with a web of quadrics is recalled in [7, §4]. Our contribution is the identification and use of its polarization *inside the intrinsic nilpotent structure of a multiplication-failure scheme*, together with the fixed-tensor corank-two calculation. We give the direct incidence comparison in §7. The weighted determinantal formula retained in Appendix A is derived coefficient by coefficient from the classical symbolic-order profile; it is not proposed as a replacement for the De Concini–Eisenbud–Procesi theory.

The historical failure-locus comparison with Ballico’s 1993 article [1] has not been completed at theorem-text level. Neither metadata nor the later failure-cycle paper can settle that comparison. This outstanding documentary issue is recorded separately from the mathematical statements proved here. The complete companion preserves the preceding manuscript, including its conductor, global-section, classificatory, and application developments, without deleting them.

2. QUADRATIC RELATIONS AND A RELATIVE RAMIFICATION FAMILY

Put $N = e(e+1)/2$ and $P = \mathbb{P}(V^*)$. Let $\mathcal{H} \subset V \otimes \mathcal{O}_P$ be the tautological hyperplane bundle. Contraction is normalized by $c_\alpha(vw) = \alpha(v)w + \alpha(w)v$.

Lemma 2.1 (Restriction and contraction). *There is a locally split exact sequence*

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathrm{Sym}^2 \mathcal{H} \longrightarrow \mathrm{Sym}^2 V \otimes \mathcal{O}_P \xrightarrow{c} V \otimes \mathcal{O}_P(1) \longrightarrow 0.$$

The cokernels of $\mathrm{Sym}^2 \mathcal{H} \rightarrow S_R \otimes \mathcal{O}_P$ and $R \otimes \mathcal{O}_P \rightarrow V \otimes \mathcal{O}_P(1)$ are naturally isomorphic. Their determinant ideals define the same degree- e hypersurface when nonzero.

Proof. Locally choose ℓ with $\alpha(\ell) = 1$. The decomposition $\mathrm{Sym}^2 V = \mathrm{Sym}^2 H \oplus H\ell \oplus \mathbb{C}\ell^2$ identifies contraction with zero, the identity, and multiplication by two on the three summands, respectively. The twist accounts for rescaling α . Both cokernels are the quotient by $R + \mathrm{Sym}^2 \mathcal{H}$; hence their zeroth Fitting ideals agree. Finally, $\det c_R$ is a section of $\det V \otimes (\det R)^* \otimes \mathcal{O}_P(e)$. $\square$

Proposition 2.2. *If R is basepoint-free, its quadratic morphism $\phi_R : P \rightarrow \mathbb{P}(R^*)$ is finite and surjective of degree 2^{e-1} . Its ramification Fitting scheme is Y_R in (1.3). Moreover,*

$$R \text{ is basepoint-free} \iff \gamma_R(HV) = S_R \text{ for every hyperplane } H \subset V. \quad (2.1)$$

Proof. The pullback of $\mathcal{O}(1)$ is $\mathcal{O}_P(2)$. A positive-dimensional projective fibre contains a curve on which this ample line bundle would be trivial. Thus the proper morphism is quasi-finite, and hence finite. Its image has dimension $e-1$ and is the whole target. Intersecting $e-1$ pulled-back hyperplanes computes its degree.

For $J = (\partial q_i / \partial x_j)$, Euler’s identity reads $J(x)x = 2(q_1(x), \dots, q_e(x))^t$. On charts where a source coordinate and a target coordinate are nonzero, choose the radial vectors first. The radial differential is a unit; its quotient is the projective differential. Removing that invertible block identifies the two ramification Fitting ideals. The contraction matrix is J^t , up to bases, so Lemma 2.1 applies.

A functional on S_R vanishing on $\gamma_R(HV)$ pulls back to one vanishing on $R + HV$. If $H = \ker \alpha$, then $(HV)^\perp = \mathbb{C}\alpha^2$. Thus such a nonzero functional exists exactly when all $q \in R$ vanish at $[\alpha]$. $\square$

Proposition 2.3 (The universal smooth open). *The set G_e° is nonempty, open, and $\mathrm{PGL}(V)$ -invariant. The determinant construction over it is a relative effective Cartier divisor $\mathcal{Y} \subset G_e^\circ \times P$, proper and smooth over G_e° . It is obtained by descent from the frame bundle of the universal quotient, and its formation commutes with arbitrary base change. Each fibre is integral, with trivial canonical bundle; for $e = 4$ it also has $H^1(\mathcal{O}) = 0$.*

Proof. Fix a p -dimensional space S and set $T = \text{Hom}(\text{Sym}^2 V, S)$. Restriction over $T \times P$ to $\text{Sym}^2 \mathcal{H}$ is a surjective evaluation map to the rank- p^2 bundle of square matrices. The incidence of corank at least two has codimension four on each fibre over P , hence dimension $\dim T + e - 5 < \dim T$. Its projection to T is proper and has proper closed image. Similarly, HV has dimension $p + e - 1$; nonsurjectivity of its restriction has codimension e and universal dimension $\dim T - 1$. Remove these two images and nonsurjective tensors. Also require invertibility of the square restriction at one fixed hyperplane. Each is a nonempty open condition on the irreducible space T , so their intersection T_1 is nonempty.

On $T_1 \times P$ the universal determinant section is nonzero on every fibre. Since a nonzero homogeneous polynomial is a non-zero-divisor on projective space over a field, its zero scheme Z is a relative Cartier divisor and is flat over T_1 . More explicitly, apply the fibrewise flatness criterion to $0 \rightarrow \mathcal{O}(-e) \rightarrow \mathcal{O} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_Z \rightarrow 0$: the first two terms are base-flat and the first map stays injective on every fibre. This also proves that the same sequence stays exact after any base change.

The total space Z is smooth over $\mathbb{C}$. Indeed, evaluation is a submersion in the tensor directions, and the determinant hypersurface of square matrices is smooth at matrices of corank one; the corank-two incidence was removed. Every fibre is a nonempty degree- e hypersurface. The generic fibre over T_1 is regular, since its local rings are localizations of the regular local rings of Z . In characteristic zero it is geometrically regular, hence smooth. The nonsmooth locus of $Z \rightarrow T_1$ is closed, and its image is closed by properness and misses the generic point. Deleting that image gives a nonempty open with smooth fibres.

Surjections $\text{Sym}^2 V \twoheadrightarrow S$ form the frame bundle of the rank- p universal quotient on $\text{Gr}(e, \text{Sym}^2 V)$. The conditions of basepoint-freeness and smooth determinant fibre depend only on the kernel. Their bad loci have closed proper projections from the corresponding projective incidences. They therefore define the asserted open downstairs. The determinant ideal, relative Cartier property, and flatness descend along the faithfully flat frame bundle; flatness with smooth geometric fibres gives smoothness. The cokernel and Fitting constructions themselves commute with arbitrary base change. The extra fixed-hyperplane condition above is used only to produce a nonempty open in T ; it is not imposed in the definition downstairs.

A smooth positive-degree hypersurface in $\mathbb{P}^{e-1}$ is integral here: distinct positive-degree components would meet and give a singular point, and repeated components are not smooth. Adjunction gives $\omega_{Y_R} = \mathcal{O}_{Y_R}$. The hypersurface sequence gives genus one when $e = 3$ and $H^1(Y_R, \mathcal{O}) = 0$ when $e = 4$. Thus the latter is a K3 surface. Smoothness of the determinant also excludes corank at least two in the square restriction, since all cofactors then vanish. $\square$

Lemma 2.4. *The algebras B_R and $B_{R'}$ are isomorphic exactly when R and R' lie in the same $\text{PGL}(V)$ -orbit.*

Proof. An isomorphism preserves the maximal ideal and its square. On their associated graded spaces it induces an isomorphism of V carrying the kernel of quadratic multiplication to the other kernel. Conversely such a linear isomorphism gives an isomorphism of the graded algebras. Scalar matrices act trivially on relation subspaces. $\square$

3. THE MULTIPLICATION IDEAL AND INTRINSIC TORSION

We first calculate on the whole Grassmannian. In this section $R \in G_e^\circ$ is fixed, and the subscript R is omitted.

Proposition 3.1 (The full Fitting presentation). *On a frame chart write $\mathcal{K} \rightarrow V \oplus S$ as $\begin{pmatrix} M \\ A_0 \end{pmatrix}$. For every $m \geq 2$,*

$$\mathcal{I}_{\widehat{D}} = (\det M) I_p(\gamma \text{Sym}^2 M). \quad (3.1)$$

The reduction of $\widehat{D}$ is the integral divisor $\widehat{\Delta}$. Its smooth locus is the rank- $e - 1$ stratum. Consequently D is the restriction of $\widehat{D}$ to the smooth locus of its reduction, and this restriction is intrinsic.

Proof. Cube-zero multiplication and the unit show, over the coefficient ring and not only on fibres, that the image of every degree $m \geq 2$ is $\mathbb{C}1 + \mathcal{K} + \mathcal{K}^2$. Its presentation is

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & M & 0 \\ 0 & A_0 & \gamma \operatorname{Sym}^2 M \end{pmatrix}.$$

Every nonzero maximal minor uses the scalar column and all e columns meeting the V -rows. Expanding on these rows proves (3.1). The graph block A_0 has no effect on this ideal. Off $\det M = 0$, the quadratic block is surjective because γ is surjective, so the ideal is the unit ideal. On the divisor it vanishes. The divisor is the usual irreducible Schubert divisor: the rank- $e - 1$ stratum is dense and integral, and every lower-rank plane is a specialization of that stratum. Equivalently the standard Schubert charts give its reduced determinantal equations.

Near a point with projection rank r , an invertible r -minor reduces the projection to $\operatorname{diag}(I_r, T)$, where the entries of the $(e - r) \times (e - r)$ block T are independent transverse coordinates. One can see their independence by varying the V -components of a basis of $K \cap S$ while keeping an invertible S -frame block fixed. The determinant equation is $\det T$. Its gradient is nonzero exactly at residual corank one. This proves the smooth-locus claim, including its assertion on the Grassmannian rather than on a chosen frame space. $\square$

On Δ put $H = \operatorname{im}(K \rightarrow V)$ and $\Lambda = K \cap S$. These give a morphism to $P \times \mathbb{P}(S)$. Define $E = \Delta \times_P Y$. The graph of K/Λ yields isomorphisms

$$\Delta \simeq \operatorname{Tot}_{P \times \mathbb{P}(S)} \operatorname{Hom}(\mathcal{H}, S/\Lambda), \quad (3.2)$$

$$E \simeq \operatorname{Tot}_{Y \times \mathbb{P}(S)} \operatorname{Hom}(\mathcal{H}, S/\Lambda). \quad (3.3)$$

Indeed the inverse construction takes the inverse image of a graph $H \rightarrow S/\Lambda$ in $H \oplus S$. Both constructions commute with base change. In particular E and Δ are smooth integral, of dimensions $ep - 2$ and $ep - 1$.

Theorem 3.2 (Ramification normal form). *On all of U the ideal of D is*

$$\mathcal{I}_D = \mathcal{I}_\Delta \mathcal{I}_E = \mathcal{I}_\Delta \cap \mathcal{I}_E^2. \quad (3.4)$$

The associated supports are exactly Δ and E . The nilradical is the invertible $\mathcal{O}_E$ -module $\mathcal{N} = \mathcal{O}_E(-\Delta)$ and is square-zero. Its annihilator recovers E as a scheme.

Proof. Near projection corank one, Gaussian operations make $M = \operatorname{diag}(I_{e-1}, t)$. The quadratic block becomes $[A, tB, t^2c]$, with $A|_{t=0} = \gamma|_{\operatorname{Sym}^2 H}$. Equation (2.1) says $[A, B]$ is onto locally; choose $AU + BV = I_p$. Multiplication by t then shows that $[A, tB, t^2c]$ and $[A, tI_p]$ have exactly the same column module. Their zeroth Fitting ideals agree. Off Y , A is invertible and (3.1) is (t) . On Y , the restriction has rank $p - 1$ by Proposition 2.3. A Schur complement gives a residual row with ideal (t, f) , where $f \bmod t$ is a local ramification equation. Thus the full ideal is

$$(t^2, tf) = t(t, f). \quad (3.5)$$

The pair t, f is a regular parameter pair cutting out E . The identity $(t) \cap (t, f)^2 = t(t, f)$ proves (3.4). These are primary ideals because their associated graded rings are polynomial rings over the integral smooth supports. At the generic point of E , neither primary component can be omitted. Their radicals are distinct, giving exactly the stated associated points. Finally the nilradical is $(t)/t(t, f)$; cancellation of t gives its module identification and annihilator $(t, f)/t(t, f)$. Both are intrinsic, so the calculation glues. $\square$

Lemma 3.3 (Generic torsion as a sheaf). *Let Z be noetherian with integral reduction and generic point η . For a coherent module $\mathcal{F}$ define*

$$\mathrm{tor}_\eta(\mathcal{F}) = \ker(\mathcal{F} \longrightarrow i_* \widetilde{\mathcal{F}}_\eta), \quad i : \mathrm{Spec} \mathcal{O}_{Z,\eta} \longrightarrow Z.$$

This kernel is coherent and is the largest coherent submodule with zero generic stalk. It is preserved by isomorphisms of schemes.

Proof. On an affine open meeting η this is the localization kernel at the prime of η . It is a submodule of a finite module over a noetherian ring, hence finite. Localization of that kernel on smaller affine opens is the corresponding kernel, so these modules glue. Every submodule with zero generic stalk lies in the kernel, and the kernel itself has zero generic stalk. The definition involves no ambient embedding or chosen primary decomposition. $\square$

Corollary 3.4 (Ordinary powers). *For $n \geq 1$, write $D^{[n]} = V(\mathcal{I}_D^n)$ and $E^{[n]} = V(\mathcal{I}_E^n)$. Then*

$$\mathcal{I}_D^n = \mathcal{I}_\Delta^n \mathcal{I}_E^n = \mathcal{I}_\Delta^n \cap \mathcal{I}_E^{2n} \quad (3.6)$$

is an irredundant primary decomposition on U . With $\mathcal{T}_n = \mathrm{tor}_{\eta_\Delta}(\mathcal{O}_{D^{[n]}})$,

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathcal{T}_n = \mathcal{O}_{E^{[n]}}(-n\Delta) \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}_{D^{[n]}} \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}_{n\Delta} \longrightarrow 0. \quad (3.7)$$

Its annihilator defines $E^{[n]}$. The generic multiplicity on Δ is n , the nilradical index along E is $2n$, and the length of $\mathcal{T}_n$ at η_E is $n(n+1)/2$.

Proof. In the local ring let $P = (t, f)$. The associated graded ring of P is a polynomial ring in two variables over $\mathcal{O}_E$, and the initial form of t is one of those variables. Hence $(P^{2n} : t^n) = P^n$, proving $(t^n) \cap P^{2n} = t^n P^n$. The same graded argument proves that these powers are primary. The witnesses t^n and f^{2n} at η_E prove irredundancy. Localizing at (t) contracts the ideal to (t^n) , so the generic torsion is $(t^n)/t^n P^n$, and cancellation gives its annihilator P^n . The class of t has index $2n$ at E , since t^{2n} belongs to the ideal but t^{2n-1} does not. At the generic point of Δ , f is a unit. Finally $\mathcal{O}_{U,\eta_E}/(t, f)^n$ has the $n(n+1)/2$ monomials of total degree less than n as successive graded basis elements. $\square$

Lemma 3.5 (Flat flags and arbitrary base change). *Let $U \rightarrow T$ be smooth, and let $E \subset \Delta \subset U$ be relative smooth closed subschemes, each inclusion a Cartier divisor. Put $L = \mathcal{I}_\Delta$ and $P = \mathcal{I}_E$. Then $\mathcal{O}_U/P^n$ and $\mathcal{O}_U/L^n$ are flat over T . For $D_n = V(L^n P^n)$ the sequence*

$$0 \rightarrow L^n \otimes \mathcal{O}_{E^{[n]}} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{D_n} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_U/L^n \rightarrow 0 \quad (3.8)$$

is exact and remains exact after any base change. Its base-changed terms are the indicated ordinary powers and products. In particular D_n is flat over T .

Proof. The immersion $E \subset U$ is regular of codimension two and has locally free conormal module. The conormal filtration of $\mathcal{O}_U/P^n$ has quotients $\mathrm{Sym}^j(P/P^2)$ on E , for $0 \leq j < n$; these are base-flat. Induction proves flatness. The analogous principal filtration proves flatness of $\mathcal{O}_U/L^n$. Multiplication by a local equation t^n of L^n identifies the kernel in (3.8) with $L^n \otimes \mathcal{O}_{E^{[n]}}$, since t is a non-zero-divisor. Both outer terms are base-flat, so the middle term is base-flat. For a base algebra $A \rightarrow A'$, the only possible left obstruction in tensoring this short exact sequence is $\mathrm{Tor}_1^A(\mathcal{O}_U/L^n, A')$, which is zero. The sequences defining L , P , and their powers stay exact for the same reason. Thus their images after base change are the actual ideals generated by the base-changed equations, and multiplication gives their stated products. No assertion about specialization of selected primary components is used. $\square$

Corollary 3.6. *Over G_e° , the schemes E , Δ , and U form the smooth relative flag of Lemma 3.5. All $D^{[n]}$ and $E^{[n]}$ are flat, and (3.7) commutes with arbitrary base change. Each complex fibre has (3.6).*

Proof. Use the universal quotient $\mathcal{S}$ and the graph bundles (3.2)–(3.3) over the smooth family of Proposition 2.3. The Fitting elimination works over the parameter ring, so it gives $t(t, f)$ relatively. Apply the lemma, and apply Corollary 3.4 separately on each fibre for the primary assertion. $\square$

4. RECOVERING THE POLARIZED RAMIFICATION VARIETY

Let $A = \mathcal{O}_Y(1)$ and $B = \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}(S)}(1)$. In the graph description (3.3) write

$$Z = Y \times \mathbb{P}(S), \quad W = \mathcal{H}^* \otimes Q, \quad Q = (S \otimes \mathcal{O})/\Lambda, \quad \pi : E = \text{Tot}_Z W \rightarrow Z,$$

and let $\rho : E \rightarrow Y$ be the composite projection. Constant one-dimensional vector-space factors in determinant lines below are suppressed; they change none of the isomorphism classes or section rings.

Lemma 4.1 (No extra fibrewise functions). *The natural map $\mathcal{O}_Y \rightarrow \rho_* \mathcal{O}_E$ is an isomorphism.*

Proof. The assertion is local on Y , where $\mathcal{H}$ can be trivialized. If H_0 is its fibre space, the affine bundle projection gives

$$\pi_* \mathcal{O}_E = \bigoplus_{d \geq 0} \text{Sym}^d(H_0 \otimes Q^*).$$

We claim that

$$H^0(\mathbb{P}(S), \text{Sym}^d(H_0 \otimes Q^*)) = 0 \quad (d > 0). \quad (4.1)$$

The injection $Q^* \hookrightarrow S^* \otimes \mathcal{O}$ embeds a global section in the constant space $\text{Sym}^d(H_0 \otimes S^*)$. Such an element is a homogeneous polynomial on $\text{Hom}(H_0, S)$. At every line $\Lambda \subset S$, membership in $\text{Sym}^d(H_0 \otimes (S/\Lambda)^*)$ says this polynomial factors through $\text{Hom}(H_0, S/\Lambda)$; it is invariant under translations by $\text{Hom}(H_0, \Lambda)$. Taking the lines of a basis of S shows invariance under every translation of $\text{Hom}(H_0, S)$. In characteristic zero such a polynomial is constant, so its positive-degree part is zero. This proves (4.1). The degree-zero part is $\mathbb{C}$.

The same calculation tensors with the coordinate ring of each affine trivializing open of Y : cohomology on the projective space commutes with this flat extension from $\mathbb{C}$, and with the displayed direct sum in degree zero. Hence the pushforward is precisely $\mathcal{O}_Y$, with its natural multiplication. The local identifications glue. $\square$

Proposition 4.2 (The canonical nilradical line). *As line bundles on E ,*

$$\mathcal{N} \simeq \pi^*(A^{-1} \boxtimes B^{-1}), \quad \omega_E \simeq \pi^*(A^{-(p-1)} \boxtimes B^{-(p+e-1)}). \quad (4.2)$$

Consequently

$$\omega_E \otimes \mathcal{N}^{\otimes -(p+e-1)} \simeq \rho^* A^e. \quad (4.3)$$

Proof. The determinant defining $\hat{\Delta}$ is a section of $(\det \mathcal{K})^* \otimes \det V$. On E the exact sequence $0 \rightarrow \Lambda \rightarrow \mathcal{K} \rightarrow \mathcal{H} \rightarrow 0$ gives $\mathcal{I}_{\Delta}|_E = \det \mathcal{H} \otimes \Lambda$, up to a constant factor. Since $\det \mathcal{H} = A^{-1}$ and $\Lambda = B^{-1}$, Theorem 3.2 gives the first formula.

The determinant of W is $(\det \mathcal{H}^*)^{p-1} \otimes (\det Q)^{e-1} = A^{p-1} \boxtimes B^{e-1}$. The canonical bundle of a vector-bundle total space is $\pi^*(\omega_Z \otimes \det W^{-1})$, as follows by taking the determinant of its relative cotangent sequence. Here $\omega_Z = \mathcal{O}_Y \boxtimes B^{-p}$ because $\omega_Y = \mathcal{O}_Y$. This proves the second formula. Subtracting the two exponents gives (4.3): the B -exponent vanishes and the A -exponent is $-(p-1) + (p+e-1) = e$. $\square$

Proof of Theorem 1.1. An isomorphism of failure schemes preserves the nilradical and its annihilator, hence E , its invertible module $\mathcal{N}$, and its canonical bundle. It therefore preserves $\mathcal{L} = \omega_E \otimes \mathcal{N}^{-(p+e-1)}$ and its graded section ring. Proposition 4.2, Lemma 4.1, and the projection formula give

$$H^0(E, \mathcal{L}^n) = H^0(Y, A^{en} \otimes \rho_* \mathcal{O}_E) = H^0(Y, A^{en})$$

compatibly with multiplication. The full section ring of the ample line bundle A^e recovers (Y, A^e) by Proj. In this case it is also the e th Veronese of the homogeneous coordinate ring of a smooth hypersurface, so there is no ambiguity about the grading line bundle.

For a K3 surface the Picard group has no torsion. Here is the short argument needed: a nontrivial torsion line bundle T and its inverse have no nonzero sections, since a nonzero effective torsion divisor has zero intersection with an ample divisor, which is impossible. Riemann–Roch and Serre duality would then give $2 = \chi(T) = -h^1(T) \leq 0$, a contradiction. Thus an isomorphism carrying A^4 to $(A')^4$ carries A to A' . This recovers the quartic polarization, and its complete linear system recovers the quartic embedding up to projective equivalence.

Finally Proposition 3.1 recovers D from $\widehat{D}$ by restricting to the smooth locus of the reduction. This operation is intrinsic and is preserved by every abstract scheme isomorphism. The preceding proof applies to that restriction. $\square$

Remark 4.3. For $e = 3$ the theorem recovers (Y, A^3) directly. A chosen cubic root in the Picard group need not be unique. As polarized genus-one curves, however, the possible degree-three roots are isomorphic: after choosing an origin, the map $y \mapsto t_y^* A \otimes A^{-1}$ onto $\text{Pic}^0(Y)$ is multiplication by three, hence surjective. No choice of an origin is needed for the stated section-ring reconstruction. For $e = 4$ the torsion-free argument gives uniqueness without translations.

Remark 4.4 (Relation to the earlier birational argument). The compactification $\mathbb{P}_Z(\mathcal{O} \oplus W)$ is birational to $Y \times \mathbb{P}^{e(p-1)}$. Thus the earlier cancellation proof is a special case of the maximal rationally connected quotient: for a non-uniruled base, that quotient of a product with projective space is the base, birationally. See the rational-quotient construction in [8, Chapter IV, §5]. This explains the earlier abstract recovery, which is retained in the companion. The present proof does not rely on that argument: the section ring gives the actual projective model and its line bundle, not merely a birational class.

5. NINE-DIMENSIONAL VARIATION IN THE K3 CASE

We prove Theorem 1.2. Work on the standard chart of $\text{Gr}(4, \text{Sym}^2 \mathbb{C}^4)$ where the four square coefficients are the identity. Write $x = (x_0, x_1, x_2, x_3)$ and order the six cross terms as

$$m = (x_0x_1, x_0x_2, x_0x_3, x_1x_2, x_1x_3, x_2x_3).$$

For $C \in \text{Mat}_{6 \times 4}$ set

$$q_i = x_i^2 + \sum_{k=1}^6 C_{ki} m_k, \quad J_C = (\partial q_i / \partial x_j), \quad F_C = \det J_C. \quad (5.1)$$

This parametrizes the relation space, not an additional choice of its basis: the square coefficients fix that basis on this chart.

Lemma 5.1 (An integral differential witness). *At the relation system*

$$C_* = \begin{pmatrix} 2 & -1 & 2 & 0 \\ -2 & 0 & -1 & 1 \\ 2 & -1 & -2 & 0 \\ 1 & -1 & 2 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 & 0 & 0 \\ 1 & -2 & 1 & -2 \end{pmatrix}, \quad (5.2)$$

the differential of $C \mapsto [F_C] \in \mathbb{P}(\text{Sym}^4 \mathbb{C}^4)$ has rank 24. This relation system is basepoint-free and $V(F_{C_*})$ is smooth over $\mathbb{C}$.

Proof. Let $\text{cof}_{ij}(J)$ denote the signed cofactor. The 24 parameter derivatives are

$$G_{ik} = \left. \frac{\partial F_C}{\partial C_{ki}} \right|_{C_*} = \sum_{j=0}^3 \text{cof}_{ij}(J_{C_*}) \frac{\partial m_k}{\partial x_j}. \quad (5.3)$$

Order degree-four monomials by descending lexicographic order of their exponent tuples, and form the 35×25 integral coefficient matrix D_* with columns F_{C_*} , followed by G_{ik} with $i = 0, \dots, 3$ outermost and $k = 1, \dots, 6$ innermost. The determinant of its first 25 rows and all columns is

$$4279473148893659522379284480 \neq 0. \quad (5.4)$$

Its residue modulo 101 is 41. Thus F_{C_*} and the 24 derivatives are linearly independent. Quotienting the target tangent space by the line spanned by F_{C_*} proves the differential assertion.

For completeness, Appendix B specifies the full coefficient recipe and two additional finite rank certificates. The Macaulay matrix of the q_i in degree five has rank 56, the dimension of all degree-five polynomials. The analogous matrix of the four partials of F_{C_*} in degree nine has rank 220, again the entire homogeneous piece. Explicit square minors are nonzero modulo 101, with residues 44 and 79. The integer matrices therefore have full row rank over $\mathbb{Q}$. Every monomial of those degrees belongs to the respective homogeneous ideal over $\mathbb{Q}$, and hence over $\mathbb{C}$. A common projective zero is impossible. This proves basepoint-freeness and smoothness without a numerical tolerance or a probabilistic test. $\square$

Proposition 5.2. *The Jacobian map on G_4° has a 24-dimensional image in the space of embedded smooth quartics. Its image in polarized quartic K3 moduli has dimension nine. Its general fibres after projective coordinate equivalence are finite.*

Proof. Changing a basis of R multiplies the determinant by a nonzero scalar, so the projective Jacobian map is well-defined. A change of coordinates in V acts equivariantly. Lemma 5.1 and the 24-dimensional domain show that its image has dimension 24 and that the map is generically finite onto that embedded image. The locus where the differential is injective is nonempty and open; it is invariant because the map is equivariant. The smooth admissible locus is irreducible by Proposition 2.3.

The projective stabilizer of a smooth quartic K3 is finite. Indeed, contraction with its nonzero two-form identifies its tangent bundle with its cotangent bundle, and $H^0(\Omega^1) = 0$ by $H^1(\mathcal{O}) = 0$ and Hodge symmetry over $\mathbb{C}$. The stabilizer, a closed finite-type subgroup of PGL_4 , therefore has zero-dimensional Lie algebra and is finite. Its orbits have dimension 15. Two smooth quartic embeddings define the same polarized K3 precisely when they are related by PGL_4 , because their embeddings are given by the complete polarizing linear systems. The geometric quotient of the smooth quartic locus gives the quartic K3 moduli space; equivalently one may compute on a generic geometric quotient. The invariant image consequently has dimension $24 - 15 = 9$ after quotienting. Standard background on polarized K3 moduli is given in [6, Chapter 5].

To check the finiteness assertion directly, take a general embedded quartic in the 24-dimensional image where the fibre is finite. Every relation system mapping to a projectively equivalent quartic can be moved by the corresponding projective transformation into that finite fibre. Thus there are only finitely many projective equivalence classes above the general polarized point. This argument also makes clear that the assertion is generic, rather than a statement about all exceptional fibres. $\square$

Proof of Theorem 1.2. Combine Proposition 5.2 with the recovery of the polarized quartic in Theorem 1.1 and the algebra-orbit equivalence of Lemma 2.4. $\square$

Corollary 5.3. *There is a flat family of failure schemes on the corank-one open whose canonical polarized invariant has a nine-dimensional image. In particular the associated K3 surfaces are*

not isotrivial, and the failure schemes are not all abstractly isomorphic. Their reduced divisors become the same scheme after identifying the vector spaces S_R of rank six.

Proof. Flatness is Corollary 3.6. A fixed abstract K3 cannot give a positive-dimensional algebraic family of polarization classes on that surface: its Picard scheme is discrete, since $H^1(\mathcal{O}) = 0$. Thus the positive-dimensional polarized image also implies non-isotriviality of the surfaces. Distinct values of the canonical polarized invariant give nonisomorphic failure schemes by Theorem 1.1. The graph description of Δ in (3.2) is independent of R . $\square$

6. FIXED TENSORS ACROSS PROJECTION CORANK TWO

We now work with $e = 4$ and $p = 6$. All calculations below concern a fixed quotient tensor γ_R , while its generating plane varies. They are identities of ideals, before taking radicals.

Definition 6.1. A pair (R, H) , where $R \in G_4^\circ$ and $H \subset V$ is a plane, is called admissible for the corank-two calculation if the following conditions hold. The map $A_H = \gamma_R|_{\text{Sym}^2 H}$ is injective. For a complement W to H , put $Q_H = S_R / \text{im } A_H$ and let

$$B_H : H \otimes W \longrightarrow Q_H, \quad C_H : \text{Sym}^2 W \longrightarrow Q_H$$

be induced by multiplication. The map B_H is surjective and its one-dimensional kernel is generated by a rank-two tensor in $H \otimes W$. Finally, the line of hyperplanes containing H meets Y_R in four distinct points.

The first-order map B_H is intrinsically a map from $H \otimes (V/H)$: changing a lift of a vector in V/H adds an element of $\text{Sym}^2 H$, which is zero in Q_H . Thus these conditions are independent of the chosen complement. The last condition is transverse intersection with a projective line, not smoothness of a parameter-selected polynomial without a geometric interpretation.

Lemma 6.2 (Nonemptiness of the corank-two open). *The admissible pairs form a nonempty open subset of $G_4^\circ \times \text{Gr}(2, V)$. Its projection is a nonempty invariant open $G_4^\dagger$. For each R in that image, the admissible H form a dense open subset of $\text{Gr}(2, V)$.*

Proof. Injectivity and surjectivity are open rank conditions. After taking the line kernel, tensor rank two is the nonvanishing of its determinant. On this locus the pencil restriction of the determinant is a binary quartic; nonzero discriminant is open. These conditions are invariant. Projection from a product over $\mathbb{C}$ is open, and $\text{Gr}(2, V)$ is irreducible, giving the density claim once nonemptiness is proved.

For C_* in (5.2), take $H = \langle x_0, x_1 \rangle$ and $W = \langle x_2, x_3 \rangle$. In the square-first, cross-second basis, $\gamma = (-C_* | I_6)$. The three columns for x_0^2, x_0x_1, x_1^2 have rank three. After quotienting their image, the remaining maps are

$$B_H = \begin{pmatrix} -1/2 & -1 & 1 & 0 \\ -1/2 & -1 & 0 & 1 \\ -3/2 & -2 & 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad C_H = \begin{pmatrix} -9/2 & 0 & -1/2 \\ -5/2 & 0 & 1/2 \\ -13/2 & 1 & 7/2 \end{pmatrix}. \quad (6.1)$$

The four columns of B_H correspond to $x_0x_2, x_0x_3, x_1x_2, x_1x_3$; the three of C_H correspond to x_2^2, x_2x_3, x_3^2 . The kernel vector is $(-4, 3, 1, 1)$, whose 2×2 determinant is -7 . For $ux_2 + vx_3$, the final square column is $C_H(u^2, 2uv, v^2)^t$. The determinant of that column and the two mixed columns is

$$h(u, v) = \frac{u^4 - 8u^3v - u^2v^2 - 4uv^3 - 9v^4}{2}, \quad \text{disc } h(u, 1) = -\frac{632301}{4} \neq 0. \quad (6.2)$$

Its leading coefficient is nonzero, so there is no root at infinity. This determinant is the restriction determinant on $\text{Sym}^2(H + \mathbb{C}(ux_2 + vx_3))$ after eliminating A_H , hence defines the pencil intersection with Y_R . Lemma 5.1 places this witness in G_4° . $\square$

Lemma 6.3 (The residual matrix). *Near a plane K whose projection has admissible rank-two image H , there are smooth auxiliary parameters and four transverse coordinates a, b, c, d in which $\mathcal{I}_{\widehat{D}_R} = \delta J$, with*

$$\begin{aligned} T &= \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix}, \quad \delta = ad - bc, \quad \mathbf{m} = (a, b, c, d), \\ L(T) &= \begin{pmatrix} a & b & 0 & 0 \\ c & d & a & b \\ 0 & 0 & c & d \end{pmatrix}, \quad T^{(2)} = \begin{pmatrix} a^2 & ab & b^2 \\ 2ac & ad + bc & 2bd \\ c^2 & cd & d^2 \end{pmatrix}, \\ J &= I_3[L(T), CT^{(2)}]. \end{aligned} \tag{6.3}$$

Here C is a 3×3 matrix depending only on the auxiliary parameters, not on a, b, c, d .

Proof. Use Proposition 3.1 and an invertible projection two-minor to write $M = \text{diag}(I_2, T)$. The basis of its first image plane and a complement can be chosen independently of the Schur block T : the Gaussian row operations depend on the first two columns, and the remaining column operations remove their components from the last two columns. This proves the asserted separation of parameters.

The quadratic columns divide into $\text{Sym}^2 H$, $H \otimes W$, and $\text{Sym}^2 W$. Eliminate the injective rank-three A_H block. The residual matrix is $[B_H(I_H \otimes T), C_H T^{(2)}]$, and its maximal minors generate the residual ideal: the eliminated identity block removes a free direct summand of the cokernel. A rank-two generator of $\ker B_H$ can be put in the form $h_1 \otimes w_2 - h_2 \otimes w_1$ by invertible changes of bases. The quotient is then the symmetrization map from two two-dimensional spaces, with the displayed matrix $L(T)$. These basis changes involve only the auxiliary parameters. Finally $\det M$ is a unit times δ . This proves the ideal identity, not just its leading term. $\square$

Let

$$h(u_1, u_2) = \det \left[\begin{pmatrix} u_1 \\ u_2 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ u_1 \\ u_2 \end{pmatrix}, C \begin{pmatrix} u_1^2 \\ 2u_1 u_2 \\ u_2^2 \end{pmatrix} \right]. \tag{6.4}$$

It is the binary quartic of the pencil intersection. After an étale extension of the auxiliary coefficient ring, its four roots split as distinct line subbundles $\ell_i \subset W$. Write P_i for the ideal of $\text{im } T \subset \ell_i$; it is generated by the two entries of the composite $\mathbb{C}^2 \xrightarrow{T} W \rightarrow W/\ell_i$.

Lemma 6.4 (A rank-one-cone computation). *Under the simple-root hypothesis, in the local coefficient ring of Lemma 6.3 one has*

$$I := \bigcap_{i=1}^4 P_i = (\delta, g_0, \dots, g_4), \quad J = I \cap \mathbf{m}^3 = \delta \mathbf{m} + (g_0, \dots, g_4). \tag{6.5}$$

The degree-four polynomials g_j can be chosen with restrictions $h(u_1, u_2)v_1^{4-j}v_2^j$ on $T = uv^t$.

Proof. Give a, b, c, d degree one and the auxiliary coefficients degree zero. The coordinate ring of the rank-one cone is the diagonal subring

$$A_0[a, b, c, d]/(\delta) \simeq \bigoplus_{r \geq 0} \text{Sym}^r(A_0^2)_u \otimes \text{Sym}^r(A_0^2)_v, \quad T = uv^t, \tag{6.6}$$

where A_0 denotes the auxiliary ring. This follows directly from $a = u_1 v_1$, $b = u_1 v_2$, $c = u_2 v_1$, $d = u_2 v_2$ and the single relation $ad - bc$; the monomials on either side give the same basis. In degree r , vanishing on the four distinct u -lines means divisibility by h in the u variables. The resulting module is zero for $r < 4$, and for $r \geq 4$ it is

$$h \text{Sym}^{r-4}(A_0^2)_u \otimes \text{Sym}^r(A_0^2)_v.$$

The simple-root discriminant is a unit, so the elementary divisibility and interpolation assertions used here hold over A_0 as well as over its residue field. Multiplication of binary forms shows that this ideal is generated in diagonal degree four by $hv_1^{4-j}v_2^j$. Lifting those generators proves the first identity.

The four 3-minors of the linear block $L(T)$ generate $\delta\mathfrak{m}$, by direct expansion. Modulo δ , its four columns are

$$v_1B(h_1u), \quad v_2B(h_1u), \quad v_1B(h_2u), \quad v_2B(h_2u),$$

and the three quadratic columns are $v_1^2C(u^2)$, $v_1v_2C(u^2)$, and $v_2^2C(u^2)$. Here u^2 has coefficient vector $(u_1^2, 2u_1u_2, u_2^2)^t$. A minor using one column from each of the two linear groups and one quadratic column is h times a degree-four monomial in v ; these span all five such monomials. Thus they furnish the lifts g_j . A minor with at least two quadratic columns vanishes modulo δ , and its degree is at least five, so it already lies in $\delta\mathfrak{m}$. All other minors have been accounted for. This proves $J = \delta\mathfrak{m} + (g_j)$ exactly.

Finally I is generated by its degree-two element δ and the g_j of degree four. Its intersection with $\mathfrak{m}^3$ deletes only the scalar multiple of δ in degree two, proving the second equality. Localizing in the auxiliary parameters or taking the indicated étale extension preserves these explicit identities. $\square$

Theorem 6.5 (The corank-two primary structure). *For an admissible pair the ideal δJ has the decomposition (1.5). It is irredundant. In the local failure ring its nilradical $\widehat{\mathcal{N}}$ satisfies*

$$\widehat{\mathcal{N}}^3 = 0, \quad \widehat{\mathcal{N}}^2 \neq 0, \quad \text{Ann}(\widehat{\mathcal{N}}^2) = \mathfrak{m}/(\delta J). \quad (6.7)$$

Consequently the rank-two stratum is intrinsic to this local scheme as the annihilator support of $\widehat{\mathcal{N}}^2$.

Proof. Work on a connected regular étale auxiliary chart, so that its coefficient ring is a domain. Each P_i is a prime generated by two independent linear coordinates. Its ordinary square is P_i -primary; the same argument applies to $\mathfrak{m}^5$. The ideal (δ) is prime. At the generic point of P_i , the determinant has order one, because the other row after choosing ℓ_i as a coordinate line is not zero. Therefore

$$(P_i^2 : \delta) = P_i, \quad (\mathfrak{m}^5 : \delta) = \mathfrak{m}^3.$$

The second equality also follows immediately from the homogeneous order two of δ and the polynomial associated graded ring of $\mathfrak{m}$. Intersecting with (δ) and cancelling δ now gives

$$(\delta) \cap \bigcap_i P_i^2 \cap \mathfrak{m}^5 = \delta \left(\bigcap_i P_i \cap \mathfrak{m}^3 \right) = \delta J$$

by Lemma 6.4.

At the generic point of the determinant divisor all the other ideals are units, so (δ) is necessary. At the generic point of P_i the other P_j and $\mathfrak{m}$ become units, and the local ideal is $\delta P_i = (\delta) \cap P_i^2$; its two components are necessary. To see that $\mathfrak{m}^5$ is necessary, note that δ^2 lies in (δ) and in every P_i^2 , but is not in δJ : $\delta \notin J$ because its degree is two. On the other hand $\mathfrak{m}\delta^2 \subset \delta J$ since $\delta\mathfrak{m} \subset J$. This also proves that the annihilator of the class of δ^2 is exactly $\mathfrak{m}$; a nonzero auxiliary coefficient cannot kill that degree-four class.

The radical of the failure ideal is (δ) , so the nilradical is generated by the class of δ . Its square is the nonzero class just considered and its cube vanishes, since $\delta^2 \in \delta\mathfrak{m} \subset J$. This proves (6.7). Over the auxiliary ring the square is free of rank one on the rank-two stratum. Intrinsically its transition functions are those of $\mathcal{L}_{\Delta}^2$ restricted to that stratum; thus it is $\mathcal{O}_{\Sigma}(-2\widehat{\Delta})$ on the admissible open Σ . The generic transverse length is one. $\square$

Proof of Theorem 1.3. Lemma 6.2 supplies the asserted nonempty open class. Lemmas 6.3 and 6.4 and Theorem 6.5 supply the fixed-tensor calculation on every indicated frame chart. The

graph coordinates are smooth auxiliary variables, so no transverse component has been discarded. The individual P_i are allowed to permute under monodromy; the intersection and the intrinsic annihilator in (6.7) descend. Four local branches need not be four distinct global irreducible components. This is why the primary decomposition was stated étale locally rather than with globally labelled roots. $\square$

7. THE CLASSICAL INCIDENCE SURFACE AND THE NEW INVARIANT

This section distinguishes three geometric objects associated with the same relation system. Let $e = 4$ and let $q_i(x, y)$ denote the symmetric bilinear polarization of $q_i(x)$, normalized by $q_i(x, x) = q_i(x)$. Define

$$Z_R = \{([x], [y]) \in \mathbb{P}(V^*) \times \mathbb{P}(V^*) : q_i(x, y) = 0 \text{ for all } i\}. \quad (7.1)$$

Proposition 7.1. *For $R \in G_4^\circ$, projection on the first factor identifies Z_R with Y_R . Transposition of the two factors induces a fixed-point-free involution on this K3 surface. The polarization recovered in Theorem 1.1 is the first projection's quartic polarization.*

Proof. The bilinear equations at x are $J_R(x)y = 0$, up to the common nonzero factor two. Off Y_R there is no projective solution; on Y_R the matrix has rank exactly three because Y_R is smooth. Inverting a nonzero three-minor gives a unique kernel line, with its scheme structure, and these kernel lines glue to an inverse for the projection $Z_R \rightarrow Y_R$. The equations are symmetric in x, y , so transposition acts. A fixed point would have $[x] = [y]$ and hence $q_i(x) = 0$ for every i , contrary to basepoint-freeness. The final assertion follows from the first projection and its hyperplane bundle. $\square$

The discriminant of the web is a different embedded hypersurface. If $q_i(x) = x^t A_i x$, its equation is

$$\det\left(\sum_{i=0}^3 \lambda_i A_i\right) = 0 \quad \text{in } \mathbb{P}(R), \quad (7.2)$$

whereas the ramification equation is $\det J_R(x) = 0$ in $\mathbb{P}(V^*)$. The former varies the quadric in the web; the latter varies a point of the source of the quadratic morphism. The two determinants must not be identified simply because both have degree four. The classical construction recalled in [7, §4] relates the bilinear K3 surface to the resolution of the web's symmetroid and to a nodal Enriques quotient; see also the account of Reye congruences in [5]. Proposition 7.1 places our ramification surface in that construction by an explicit kernel-line isomorphism. No claim is made that the existence of that K3 surface, its involution, or webs of quadrics is new.

The invariant used here starts instead with the abstract multiplication-failure scheme. It obtains E as the annihilator of its nilradical, constructs $\omega_E \otimes \mathcal{N}^{-9}$ without the web or either projective space, and recovers the section ring of $\mathcal{O}_{Y_R}(4)$. The corank-two theorem further recovers an additional associated support from the square of the nilradical. These are statements about nonreduced multiplication-failure schemes, not merely about the classical incidence surface or the discriminant cycle.

APPENDIX A. WEIGHTED DETERMINANTAL FLAGS AND THE CLASSICAL ORDER PROFILE

We record explicitly how the retained weighted-matrix calculation fits the classical determinantal theory. This comparison concerns the generic matrix only; the fixed-tensor theorem of §6 was proved independently.

Let $A = (a_{ij})$ be a generic $q \times p$ matrix over a characteristic-zero field k , with $p \geq q$, and put $R_0 = k[a_{ij}]$, $I_0(A) = R_0$. For a nonincreasing sequence $\rho = (r_1, \dots, r_s)$ write

$$I^\rho = \prod_{\nu=1}^s I_{r_\nu}(A), \quad \gamma_j(\rho) = \sum_{\nu=1}^s \max(r_\nu - j + 1, 0).$$

The classical formula is

$$I^\rho = \bigcap_{j=1}^{r_1} I_j(A)^{(\gamma_j(\rho))}. \quad (\text{A.1})$$

Here the superscript in parentheses denotes symbolic power. See De Concini–Eisenbud–Procesi [4], and its statement as Theorem 2.4 in Bruns–Conca [2], together with Proposition 2.2 there for the symbolic-order basis. The characteristic hypotheses and attribution are stated on printed pages 13–14 of that exposition.

Proposition A.1 (Coefficientwise suspension). *In $R_0[t]$, put*

$$F = t \sum_{i=0}^q t^{q-i} I_i(A), \quad P_j = (t, I_j(A)).$$

Then

$$F = (t) \cap \bigcap_{j=1}^q P_j^{(q-j+2)}. \quad (\text{A.2})$$

This is an irredundant primary decomposition. At a point with $t = 0$ where A has rank a , the nilradical of the corresponding local quotient has index $q - a + 1$.

Proof. In the regular local ring $(R_0)_{I_j}$, the symbolic order of an i -minor is $\max(i - j + 1, 0)$. Adjoining t gives the coefficient rule

$$\sum_{u \geq 0} t^u f_u \in P_j^{(b)} \iff f_u \in I_j^{(\max(b-u, 0))} \text{ for every } u. \quad (\text{A.3})$$

For precision, the associated graded ring of the maximal ideal $(t, I_j(R_0))_{I_j}$ is a polynomial ring over its residue field; its homogeneous t -degrees are independent. The order of the displayed sum is therefore the minimum of $u + \text{ord}_{I_j}(f_u)$. Contracting the maximal-ideal power proves (A.3), including the assertion that each contracted symbolic power is primary.

Intersecting with (t) deletes coefficient degree zero. For $1 \leq u \leq q$, put $k = q + 1 - u$. The remaining coefficient conditions on the right of (A.2) are

$$f_u \in \bigcap_{j=1}^k I_j^{(k-j+1)} = I_k,$$

the one-factor case $\rho = (k)$ of (A.1). For $u \geq q + 1$ there is no condition. These are exactly the coefficients of F , proving the equality.

For irredundancy, let d_{j-1} be a fixed $(j-1)$ -minor, with $d_0 = 1$. The element $t^{q-j+1} d_{j-1}^2$ belongs to every component other than $P_j^{(q-j+2)}$. Indeed, its order along P_j is $q - j + 1$, while at P_k for $k < j$ its order is $q - j + 1 + 2(j - k) \geq q - k + 2$, and for $k > j$ its t -order suffices. The element d_q^2 witnesses the necessity of (t) . The associated primes are therefore exactly the displayed radicals.

After inverting an a -minor and Schur reducing, the localized coefficient ideal contains t^{q-a+1} , whereas t^{q-a} has coefficient one in degree $q - a$, where membership would require a one-minor of the residual matrix. That coefficient ideal is proper at the point. Thus the radical (t) has the asserted exact index. $\square$

The exponent $q - j + 2$ is therefore the scalar-variable suspension of the classical minor order $k - j + 1$, taken coefficientwise. This is a direct consequence of the classical profile plus (A.3); it is not a new straightening theorem. The presentation $I_q[A, tI_q] = \sum_i t^{q-i} I_i(A)$ can also be viewed as substituting a scalar identity block in a larger generic matrix. Such substitution alone does not justify preservation of primary components or flatness. The coefficient proof is what supplies the exact intersection here, while the ideal $\delta\mathbf{m} + (g_0, \dots, g_4)$ in §6 requires its separate fixed-tensor analysis.

APPENDIX B. AN EXPLICIT SYSTEM AND EXACT CERTIFICATE SPECIFICATIONS

The rational system used throughout is the following. It is the same relation system as in the preceding manuscript's exact smoothness example, now used for a differential and a higher-corank calculation.

$$\begin{aligned} q_0 &= x_0^2 + 2x_0x_1 - 2x_0x_2 + 2x_0x_3 + x_1x_2 + x_1x_3 + x_2x_3 \\ q_1 &= -x_0x_1 - x_0x_3 + x_1^2 - x_1x_2 - x_1x_3 - 2x_2x_3 \\ q_2 &= 2x_0x_1 - x_0x_2 - 2x_0x_3 + 2x_1x_2 + x_2^2 + x_2x_3 \\ q_3 &= x_0x_2 + x_1x_2 - 2x_2x_3 + x_3^2 \end{aligned}$$

For a compact complete specification of its quartic, list the 35 degree-four exponent tuples in descending lexicographic order, starting with $(4, 0, 0, 0)$ and ending with $(0, 0, 0, 4)$. The coefficients of $F = \det(\partial q_i / \partial x_j)$ in that order are the rows of

$$\begin{pmatrix} -8 & -4 & -20 & 16 & 20 & 0 & -28 \\ -2 & -36 & 40 & 20 & -50 & -20 & -26 \\ 72 & -6 & 0 & -66 & -6 & 30 & 4 \\ -14 & -4 & -6 & -12 & 28 & 18 & -56 \\ 28 & 6 & -18 & 8 & -2 & 16 & 2 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Thus this display, together with the fixed monomial order, specifies every coefficient, including zeros. Alternatively, the determinant of the displayed four quadrics is its coordinate-free recipe.

For any list of homogeneous forms $f_1, \dots, f_s$ define the degree- d Macaulay coefficient matrix $\mathcal{M}_d(f)$ as follows. Rows are all degree- d monomials in the same descending lexicographic order. Columns are the forms $x^\beta f_i$, with i outermost and all β of degree $d - \deg f_i$ in descending lexicographic order innermost. The entry in row α is the coefficient of x^α . All entries for this example are integers.

Matrix	Size	Certified rank	Minor modulo 101
$[F, G_{01}, \dots, G_{36}]$	35×25	25	41
$\mathcal{M}_5(q_0, q_1, q_2, q_3)$	56×80	56	44
$\mathcal{M}_9(F_{x_0}, F_{x_1}, F_{x_2}, F_{x_3})$	220×336	220	79

The differential minor consists of the first 25 rows and all columns; its full integer value is (5.4). The following deterministic rule specifies the other two minors without printing large matrices. Reduce the displayed coefficient matrix modulo 101. Scan columns from left to right. At the next pivot step choose the first remaining row with nonzero entry, exchange it with the next pivot row, normalize that row, and eliminate below. Skip a column if there is no nonzero remaining entry. Record the original row indices in the order selected and the pivot columns. The square submatrix of the *original*, unreduced matrix with exactly these row and column orders has the residue in the final column of the table. Full recorded index lists, along with the coefficient-generating program, are included in `evidence/K3_CERTIFICATES.json` and `checks/exact_k3.py`.

Every step is finite-field arithmetic on integer data. A nonzero residue of a specified square minor proves that integer minor is nonzero, so it proves a rank statement over $\mathbb{Q}$, not merely a rank in one numerical specialization. The Macaulay rank statements imply the homogeneous ideal containments used in Lemma 5.1. The exact integer determinant is also recomputed independently with rational-domain elimination. No floating-point rank, tolerance, or unverified smoothness inference is used.

For the corank-two quotient in (6.1), one may reproduce its quotient map by multiplying the six-dimensional quadratic quotient by

$$\begin{pmatrix} 0 & -1/2 & -1 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & -1/2 & -1 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -3/2 & -2 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

This matrix annihilates the three columns of $\text{Sym}^2 H$ and has rank three. It yields the displayed B_H, C_H and the quartic (6.2) by ordinary multiplication. The factor 2 in the coefficient of uv is essential: it records the square of $ux_2 + vx_3$, not a divided-power convention.

An additional exact regression test uses the normalized matrix (6.3) with

$$C = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1/2 & -3 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Then $h(u, v) = uv(u-v)(u-2v)$, so the four ideals are (a, b) , (c, d) , $(a-c, b-d)$, and $(a-2c, b-2d)$. Elimination computes both sides of (1.5) over $\mathbb{Q}$, and mutual Gröbner reduction verifies their equality. It also checks that δ^2 is nonzero, that every element of $\mathfrak{m}\delta^2$ vanishes, and that $\delta^3 = 0$. This test checks a concrete instance; the general coefficient-ring proof is Lemma 6.4 and Theorem 6.5, not an extrapolation from that instance.

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